

FREE GUIDE

How to organize the magic for your town's festival

A practical guide for festival officers and cultural departments: which format to choose, how to prepare paperwork in advance, and how to plan your calendar without last-minute surprises.

1. Start with the type of event and the venue

Programming magic for a local festival in the main square isn't the same as for a medieval fair, a parade, or an activity at a day centre. The magic format should be decided only once the type of event, the available space and the expected audience are clear.

Details to have clear before contacting suppliers

- ☐ Type of event (local festival, fair, parade, municipal activity...)
- ☐ Venue: open square, pedestrian street, indoor venue, theatre
- ☐ Time slot and available duration
- ☐ Expected audience (ages, approximate numbers)

2. Choose the format based on the moment in the programme

Stage magic show

Works very well as the central event of the festival programme, at a fixed time announced in advance.

Street or roving magic

Ideal for the busiest hours, moving between stalls and terraces while people freely enjoy the venue.

Season programming at a municipal theatre

If the town has a theatre, magic can also be programmed as part of the cultural season, not just for one-off festivals.

3. Let's handle the paperwork in advance

Municipal contracting always comes with its own paperwork, and you already have that far more under control than we do. What we can offer is having our side ready well in advance —invoice, technical report, liability insurance and

anything else needed— so it doesn't become a bottleneck right before the event. The sooner it's all confirmed, the less room there is for last-minute surprises.

4. Key questions to ask before hiring

- Do they have real experience performing in a square, not just indoors?
- Can they show video of real performances at other towns?
- What does the town council need to provide on the day?
- Does the same show adapt to all ages at once?

5. Plan your calendar with margin

High-season dates (summer, local festivals, Christmas) fill up months in advance. Starting to request quotes as soon as you have an approximate programme helps secure your chosen supplier's availability.

Want help planning the magic for your town's festival?

Talk to us

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